

AI-Assisted UX Research Prompt

Project Title: AI-Assisted UX Research for an Automated Personal Expense Tracking App

Project Background

I am a product designer exploring the design of a mobile application that helps users understand and manage their daily spending. The core concept of the product is automatic expense tracking using banking notifications. In many countries, including Iran, banks send push notifications or SMS messages whenever a transaction occurs. The proposed application reads these notifications, extracts transaction information, categorizes expenses automatically, and provides clear financial insights to the user.

The fundamental problem this project addresses is that most people struggle to track where their money goes. Transactions are fragmented across multiple bank cards, payment gateways, and digital services. Users often want to manage their finances but avoid manual expense entry because it is tedious and time-consuming.

The proposed solution aims to remove this friction by automatically collecting and organizing transaction data from banking notifications.

Why This Research Is Being Conducted with AI

Traditional UX research relies on recruiting participants, conducting interviews, and distributing surveys. For early-stage product exploration, this process can be slow and resource-intensive.

This project explores an alternative approach: AI-assisted research.

Two complementary research strategies will be used: 1. Synthetic User Simulation – generating realistic user personas and simulated responses. 2.

Real-World Signal Mining – extracting insights from existing user comments, reviews, and discussions on the internet.

The goal is not to replace real users entirely but to accelerate early discovery and identify patterns that can inform product design.

Your task as an AI research system is to simulate a structured UX research process and produce raw research data that resembles what a real UX researcher might collect during early discovery.

Research Goals

The research should help answer the following questions:

- How do people currently track or manage their spending?
- What frustrations do users experience with existing financial apps?
- Why do users stop using expense tracking tools?
- How many bank cards do typical users manage?
- How often do users review their spending behavior?
- What concerns do users have about privacy when apps read banking notifications?
- What features would make automated expense tracking valuable to them?

The output should provide qualitative and quantitative signals that can later be used to build:

- Affinity diagrams
- User personas
- Behavioral patterns
- Product insights

CATEGORY A — SYNTHETIC USER RESEARCH

Goal

Generate a realistic dataset of simulated users and their responses to survey and interview questions about personal finance management.

Sample Size

Create approximately 60 synthetic participants.

User Diversity

Ensure diversity in: * age * profession * income level * financial literacy * number of bank cards * technology familiarity * usage of fintech apps

Example user segments may include: * salaried employees * freelancers with variable income * university students * small business owners * heavy fintech users * traditional banking users

Step 1 — Define Participant Profiles

For each participant, generate: * age * occupation * approximate monthly income range * number of bank cards * number of banking apps used * digital literacy level * typical payment habits

Step 2 — Simulated Survey Responses

Each synthetic user should respond to a structured questionnaire addressing:

- How many bank cards do you regularly use?
- How often do you review your spending?
- Do you currently use any expense tracking apps?
- What is the most frustrating part of managing personal finances?
- Would you trust an app that reads bank notifications to track expenses automatically?
- What is your biggest concern about such an app? (privacy, security, accuracy, etc.)

Responses should appear realistic and varied.

Step 3 — Simulated Interview Responses

For each user, generate short interview-style answers to questions such as:

- Describe how you usually keep track of your spending.
- Tell me about a time when you realized you spent more than expected.
- How do banking notifications influence your awareness of spending?
- What would make a finance app truly helpful for you?

Responses should reflect the user's context and lifestyle.

Step 4 — Extract User Quotes

From each interview produce a few short quotes representing key sentiments or frustrations.

Examples of quote style: * "I use three cards and at the end of the month I honestly have no idea where my money went." * "Manual expense apps are great for two days and then I forget to log anything."

Step 5 — Produce Synthetic Research Dataset

The final output for Category A should include:

- participant profile
- survey responses
- interview responses
- representative quotes

This dataset should resemble raw UX research material.

CATEGORY B — REAL WORLD SIGNAL MINING

Goal

Extract real user sentiments from public discussions about financial apps, budgeting tools, and banking experiences.

Focus

Collect comments that reveal user frustrations, expectations, and behaviors related to managing personal finances.

Step 1 — Identify Relevant Apps

Look for reviews and discussions about apps such as:

International apps * Mint * YNAB (You Need A Budget) * Spendee * PocketGuard * Revolut

Regional or banking apps * mobile banking apps * fintech wallets * budgeting tools

Step 2 — Identify Data Sources

Search across:

- Google Play reviews
- Apple App Store reviews
- Reddit discussions
- Twitter / X posts
- blog comments
- fintech forums

Step 3 — Extract Meaningful User Statements

Collect comments that describe real user experiences.

Examples: * frustrations about manual expense logging * complaints about categorization errors * requests for automation * concerns about privacy or security

Step 4 — Filter Noise

Remove comments that are not useful for UX insights, such as:

- installation problems
- spam
- insults without context

Focus only on comments describing user experience or expectations.

Step 5 — Build a Real User Feedback Dataset

Produce a dataset containing:

- user quote
- platform or source
- general theme of the comment

Aim to collect roughly 100–150 meaningful quotes.

EXPECTED OUTPUT FROM THE AI SYSTEM

The final research output should include:

1. Synthetic user dataset (~60 participants)
2. Aggregated survey observations
3. Interview quotes
4. Real-world user quotes from online sources
5. Observed behavioral patterns or recurring themes

The output should resemble raw UX research material that could realistically be used to build affinity diagrams and personas.

Important The purpose of this research is exploratory discovery for product design. Focus on generating realistic human behavior patterns rather than theoretical analysis.

The research should prioritize authenticity of user sentiment, behavioral diversity, and practical insights related to financial tracking behavior.

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